

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title: A Randomized, Double-blind, Double-dummy, Placebo-controlled, Multicenter, Phase 3 Study Assessing the Efficacy, Safety, and Tolerability of 2 Doses of Remibrutinib Over a 68-week Treatment Period in Adult Patients With Moderate to Severe Hidradenitis Suppurativa **Short Title/Acronym:** Study to Assess Efficacy Safety and Tolerability of Remibrutinib in Adult Patients With Moderate to Severe Hidradenitis Suppurativa (RECHARGE-2) **Protocol Number:** CLOU064J12302 (also 2024-513266-19-00) **NCT Number:** NCT06840392 **Posting ID:** 79143194792357689 **Trial Status:** RECRUITING **Sponsor Name:** Novartis (Novartis Pharmaceuticals) **Investigational Product:** Remibrutinib (LOU064) Dose A and Dose B **Phase of Development:** Phase III **Medical Monitor:** Novartis Clinical Operations Lead

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective **Primary Objective:** To establish the efficacy, safety, and tolerability of remibrutinib (LOU064) Dose A and Dose B compared to placebo in participants with moderate to severe hidradenitis suppurativa (HS). **Secondary Objectives:** To evaluate the proportion of participants achieving Abscesses and inflammatory nodules 50 (AN50) response at Week 16, the percentage change from baseline in International Hidradenitis Suppurativa Severity Score System (IHS4) at Week 16, the proportion of participants achieving HiSCR75 response at Week 16, and to assess long-term safety and tolerability.

2.2 Background & Rationale To address the unmet medical need for novel, effective oral therapies for moderate to severe hidradenitis suppurativa (HS). HS is a chronic, treatment-resistant inflammatory skin disease marked by painful nodules, abscesses, and sinus tracts. Remibrutinib is a highly selective oral Bruton's tyrosine kinase (BTK) inhibitor that targets inflammatory pathways implicated in HS pathophysiology, offering a promising alternative for patients unresponsive to existing therapies.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework **Study Type:** Interventional **Control Type:** Placebo-controlled (Placebo 1, Placebo 2) **Blinding:** Double-blind, double-dummy **Randomization:** Randomized, multicenter, parallel assignment

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration Target \$\$\$: 555 participants
Number of Sites: Approximately 138 locations globally **Estimated Study Start:** 20-Mar-2025 **Estimated Primary Completion:** 29-Oct-2027

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. Male and female participants ≥ 18 years of age at the time of signing the informed consent. 2. Diagnosis of HS based on clinical history and physical examination for at least 6 months prior to the Baseline visit. 3. Participants with moderate to severe HS defined as: A total of at least 5 AN count (abscesses and/or inflammatory nodules) AND inflammatory lesions affecting at least 2 distinct anatomic areas (e.g., left and right axillae).

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Presence of more than 20 fistulae/tunnels (both draining and non-draining) in total at baseline. 2. Any active skin disease or conditions that may interfere with the assessment of HS. 3. Previous exposure to remibrutinib or other BTK inhibitors. 4. Use of other investigational drugs within 5 half-lives of enrollment, or within 30 days (for small molecules) prior to randomization, or until the pharmacodynamic effect has returned to baseline (for biologics), whichever is longer. 5. Significant bleeding risk or coagulation disorders; history of gastrointestinal bleeding. 6. Requirement for anti-platelet (except for acetylsalicylic acid up to 100 mg/d or clopidogrel up to 75 mg/d) or anti-coagulant medication. 7. History or current hepatic disease. 8. Evidence of clinically significant cardiovascular, neurological, psychiatric, pulmonary, renal, hepatic, endocrine, metabolic, hematological disorders, gastrointestinal disease or immunodeficiency that would compromise safety, interfere with result interpretation, or preclude participation. 9. History of hypersensitivity to any of the study drug constituents. 10. Known or suspected infectious disease that is active, chronic, or recurrent (e.g., opportunistic infections like tuberculosis, atypical mycobacterioses, listeriosis, aspergillosis, or HIV) which precludes trial participation. 11. History of live attenuated vaccine administration within 6 weeks prior to randomization or requirement to receive these vaccinations while on study treatment. 12. Major surgery within 8 weeks prior to screening or planned surgery for the duration of the study.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen Dosage/Frequency: Remibrutinib Dose A, Remibrutinib Dose B, or matching placebos administered orally. **Route of Administration:** Oral **Duration of Treatment:** 76 weeks total (Screening up to 4 weeks; Treatment Period 1 [16 weeks, double-blind treatment with remibrutinib or placebo]; Treatment

Period 2 [52 weeks, active remibrutinib treatment]; Safety Follow-Up [4 weeks treatment-free follow-up]).

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy Permitted: Standard allowed concomitant medications for HS symptom management as defined by the protocol. **Prohibited:** Use of other investigational drugs within specified windows prior to randomization; other BTK inhibitors; anti-platelet medications (except for acetylsalicylic acid up to 100 mg/d or clopidogrel up to 75 mg/d) or anti-coagulant medications due to significant bleeding risks; live attenuated vaccines.

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures
Screening	Weeks -4 to 0	Informed Consent, Medical History, HS Lesion Assessment, HIV/TB screening
Baseline	Day 0	Randomization, First Dose, Baseline AN count and IHS4 evaluation
Interim 1	Week 16	Primary Efficacy Assessment (HiSCR50), Safety Labs, End of Double-Blind Period
Interim 2	Week 68	End of Active Treatment Period 2, Final Efficacy Assessments
End of Study	Week 72	Final Safety Follow-Up (4 weeks post-treatment), Exit Interview, IP Accountability

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint Definition: Proportion of participants with Hidradenitis Suppurativa clinical response 50 (HiSCR50) at Week 16. (HiSCR50 is defined as at least a 50% decrease in Abscess and Inflammatory Nodule [AN] count with no increase in the number of abscesses and in the number of draining tunnels/fistulae compared to baseline). **Measurement Method:** Standardized Clinical Investigator Assessment of lesion counts.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints

1. Proportion of participants with Abscesses and inflammatory nodules 50 (AN50) response at Week 16.
2. Percentage change from baseline in International Hidradenitis Suppurativa Severity Score System (IHS4) at Week 16.
3. Proportion of participants with HiSCR75 response at Week 16.
4. Incidence of treatment emergent adverse events (TEAEs) and serious adverse events (SAEs) during the study.

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring: Standard collection via clinical evaluations, lab tests, and patient reports throughout the 76-week study duration. **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** Reported within 24 hours of investigator awareness. **Data Monitoring**

Committee (DMC): Independent Data Monitoring Committee established for ongoing safety surveillance.

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

Analysis Populations: Intent-to-Treat (ITT) population for primary efficacy evaluation; Safety Set for all AE/SAE evaluations. **Sample Size Justification:** $N=555$ adequately powered ($\alpha = 0.05$) to detect statistically significant differences in HiSCR50 response rates between the remibrutinib dose groups and the placebo group at Week 16. **Handling of Missing Data:** Non-Responder Imputation (NRI) utilized for binary clinical response endpoints (like HiSCR50/HiSCR75) and Multiple Imputation for continuous variables, per standard HS Phase III guidelines.

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

GCP Compliance: This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki. **Monitoring Plan:** Routine onsite and remote monitoring visits to ensure data integrity, protocol adherence, and patient safety. **Audit Trail:** Robust electronic data capture (EDC) system with full audit trails, eCRF locking, and data clarification mechanisms.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: CLOU064J12302 **Registry Number:** NCT06840392 **Posting ID:** 79143194792357689 **Sponsor/Lead Organization:** Novartis Pharmaceuticals **Study Title:** Study to Assess Efficacy Safety and Tolerability of Remibrutinib in Adult Patients With Moderate to Severe Hidradenitis Suppurativa **Official Regulatory Title:** A Randomized, Double-blind, Double-dummy, Placebo-controlled, Multicenter, Phase 3 Study Assessing the Efficacy, Safety, and Tolerability of 2 Doses of Remibrutinib Over a 68-week Treatment Period in Adult Patients With Moderate to Severe Hidradenitis Suppurativa

12. Clinical Framework (Hidradenitis Suppurativa Specific)

Primary Condition: Moderate to Severe Hidradenitis Suppurativa (HS) **Diagnosis Threshold:** Total ≥ 5 AN count (abscesses and/or inflammatory nodules) affecting ≥ 2 distinct anatomic areas **Medical Methodology:** Bruton's Tyrosine Kinase (BTK) Inhibition **Optimization Target:** HiSCR50 achievement, HiSCR75 achievement, and reduction in IHS4 severity score at Week 16

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

Management Pathway: Double-blind, double-dummy, placebo-controlled Phase III clinical pathway **Education Protocol (HCP):** Protocol-specific training for standardized HS lesion counting (HiSCR, IHS4, AN counts) and rigorous safety monitoring **Education Protocol (Patient):** Informed consent, medication compliance, maintaining symptom diaries, and safety reporting education **Quality Audit Mechanism:** Centralized review of clinical endpoints, site monitoring, and compliance verification

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

Total Duration: 76 weeks (including 4-week safety follow-up) **Onsite Visit Cadence:** Periodic visits distributed across the 16-week double-blind and 52-week active treatment periods **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** As specified in the sponsor's clinical monitoring plan **Checklist Review Interval:** Ongoing review of TEAEs, concomitant medications, and patient-reported outcomes

15. Sign-off & Approval

	Role		Name		Signature		Date			:---		:---		:---		:---	
	Principal Investigator				[Insert Name]			_____		[DD-MMM-YYYY]							
	Clinical Operations Lead				[Insert Name]			_____		[DD-MMM-YYYY]							
	Lead Statistician				[Insert Name]			_____		[DD-MMM-YYYY]							